



SAMIR AKHTAR

Linked in



✉ samirakhtar@gmail.com

☎ +91 97310 60606

📍 Bengaluru, India

Director for India & International Marketing | SaaS Growth, Partnerships & Revenue

Driving Marketing & Product-Led Growth Across SaaS, Cloud & Enterprise Technologies Through Ecosystem GTM, Demand Generation, Strategic Alliances, Field Marketing & High-Performance Global Teams

KEY HIGHLIGHTS



\$19.2M Pipeline Delivered in 2025



181% FY25 Attainment



0→1 Built Marketing Engine



\$4.8M MDF Ownership



70+ Partner NPS Scores

CAREER TIMELINE



Freshworks

Director - International Demand Gen Marketing (Field & Partnerships)

Jun 2024 – Present

Director - Startup

Programs, ISVs & Affiliates

Jun 2023 – May 2024

Director - Global Partner Marketing & Programs

May 2022 – May 2023



IBM India

Leader - Asia Pacific Software Partner Ecosystem Marketing

Jun 2017 – Apr 2022

Manager - Global Business Partner Marketing & Enablement

Jul 2016 – May 2017

Manager - Global Business Partner Insights & Analysis

Jan 2013 – Jul 2016

Portfolio Marketing Manager & Team Leader - GMC Performance Management

May 2010 – Dec 2012



SBI Life Insurance Co. Ltd.

Regional Coordinator - Marketing

Jun 2008 – May 2010

PROFILE SUMMARY

India marketing leader with 18+ years driving enterprise pipeline and revenue across hybrid cloud, SaaS, and ecosystem-led GTM — combining country-level market ownership with deep partner, field, and digital execution. Proven track record building full-funnel marketing engines in high-growth B2B tech, co-marketing with GSIs and hyperscalers (AWS), owning multi-million-dollar MDF budgets, and aligning with Sales leadership to accelerate pipeline velocity and bookings across India's enterprise, banking, and public sector markets.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Field & Partnership Leadership

- Marketing GTM Strategy
- Partner & Alliance Marketing
- ISV Ecosystem Growth
- Sales Interlocks
- Strategic Co-Selling

Revenue & Demand Generation

- ABM Strategy
- Pipeline Growth
- Integrated Campaigns
- Field Leadership
- Demand Generation
- Brand positioning

Executive & Business Leadership

- Global Team Leadership
- India Center Leader
- GTM Transformation
- Stakeholder Alignment
- Revenue Growth

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP IMPACT

Field, Partnerships & Alliance Strategy:

- Architected India country marketing strategy aligned to India Sales leadership pipeline targets and quarterly revenue plans.
- Generated \$19.2M pipeline with 181% FY25 alliance-led attainment
- Orchestrated AWS co-sell activations, marketplace programs, and alliance campaigns across international markets.
- Expanded ecosystem engagement through structured partner segmentation, activation cadences, and localized regional motions.
- Drove CXO engagement across India enterprise, BFSI, and public sector through roundtables, ET Summits, CII events, and Gartner Symposiums India.

Revenue Growth & Demand Generation:

- Accelerated pipeline growth through ABM and partner-led campaigns.
- Scaled global MDF investments from \$2.4M to \$4.8M without budget reductions globally.
- Engineered KPI-driven models improving pipeline conversion and CAC efficiency.
- Delivered pipeline acceleration through APAC summits and GITEX activations

Global GTM & Marketing Transformation:

- Institutionalized Pod-based operating structures improving global campaign scalability.
- Modernized partner marketing using Copilot, Freddy AI, and SFDC.
- Standardized governance across APAC, EMEA, LATAM, and AMER regions.
- Directed geo-customized GTM strategies across international partner markets.

Leadership & Organizational Development:

- Built high-performing global teams across APAC, EMEA, and Americas.
- Fostered ownership-driven cultures emphasizing operational rigor and accountability.
- Guided cross-functional teams through agile, KPI-driven execution frameworks.
- Established scalable operations hubs improving reporting and responsiveness globally.

Executive Influence & Industry Impact:

- Secured executive sponsorship through ROI-focused marketing storytelling initiatives.
- Architected APAC advisory council strengthening ecosystem collaboration initiatives.
- Elevated visibility through GITEX, NRF, and DigiGov Expo participation.
- Earned ET recognition alongside multiple Freshworks and IBM honors.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Accomplishments @ Freshworks

As Director - International Demand Gen Marketing (Field & Partnerships) | Jun 2024 – Present

- Responsible for aligning corporate strategy with regional execution through integrated field and partner marketing programs, ecosystem activations, and targeted demand generation initiatives.
- Drive engagement through executive programs, industry events, and partner-led campaigns that strengthen market presence, accelerate pipeline velocity and enable sales teams to win in highly competitive enterprise and public sector environments.
- Localized global brand and campaign narratives for India and regional markets, ensuring relevance across enterprise, public sector and partner audiences (e.g. McLaren partnership).
- Lead and mentor a high-performing team based out of India (Bangalore, Chennai & Hyderabad locations), responsible for field marketing, partner marketing, and alliance marketing initiatives.
- Led Alliance marketing remit leading to Strategic Collaboration Agreement (SCA) with Amazon Web Services, driving comarketing campaigns, Marketplace activations, joint webinars and AWS-funded GTM initiatives.
- Led large-scale owned and third-party executive marketing programs across India, EMEA and APAC to create brand amplification and pipeline generation such as proprietary Testdrives workshops, India SMB Connect, CII Confederation events, ET Summits, Timesgroup activations, global Refresh events, India Partner Days, DigiGov Expo UK, NRF New York. Joint custodian of regional activations such as Bangalore Techshots, Gartner Events, Mumbai Experience Events, ICC IPL Watch parties, India AWS Summits.

As Director - Startup Programs, ISVs & Affiliates | Jun 2023 – May 2024

- Established APAC startup ecosystem programs strengthening Freshworks visibility across high-growth SaaS communities globally.
- Activated VC-led roadshows expanding ecosystem engagement across startups, agencies, and strategic technology partners.
- Collaborated with alliances teams developing integrated narratives supporting co-sell and marketplace expansion initiatives.
- Instituted attribution dashboards enhancing ecosystem visibility, engagement analytics, and marketing optimization across regions.

As Director - Global Partner Marketing & Programs | May 2022 – May 2023

- Built Freshworks global partner marketing function from ground-up across reseller, distributor, and strategic alliance ecosystems.
- Instituted agile governance frameworks enhancing scalability across global partner marketing operations worldwide.
- Rolled out Campaign-in-a-Box frameworks accelerating regional partner demand-generation consistency globally.
- Structured onboarding and enablement cadences improving global partner activation and productivity metrics.

Accomplishments @ IBM India

As Leader - Asia Pacific Software Partner Ecosystem Marketing | Jun 2017 – Apr 2022

- Directed APAC partner ecosystem marketing driving pipeline growth, enablement, and investment governance regionally.
- Led ABM-led GTM programs with GSIs, ISVs, and segmented partners across Asia-Pacific enterprise technology markets.
- Elevated partner experiences metrics achieving 70+ NPS across eight ecosystem Moments of Truth initiatives.
- Architected APAC Business Partner Advisory Council strengthening executive collaboration across regional ecosystems.
- Spearheaded IBM Partner World University programs enhancing partner competencies and regional enablement effectiveness.
- Guided digital-first ecosystem transformation leveraging Seismic and My Digital Marketing platforms for scalable partner engagement.

As Manager - Global Business Partner Marketing & Enablement | Jul 2016 – May 2017

- Transformed global co-marketing structures improving scalability and worldwide partner execution efficiency significantly.
- Launched Gross-to-Net investment framework strengthening pipeline accountability and partner marketing visibility globally.
- Directed practitioner teams supporting enablement operations and strategic co-marketing governance initiatives globally.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS	AWARDS & RECOGNITION
♦ ISB Executive Leadership Certification Indian School of Business 2025 ♦ MBA – Marketing Christ College Institute of Management 2008 ♦ BTech – Biotechnology Sam Higginbottom University 2006 ♦ Executive Program on Business Acumen IBM Institute of Business Value 2020 ♦ IBM Certified Manager IBM Co-Marketing Ambassador ♦ IBM Agile Explorer IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Co-Creator ♦ IBM Marketing & Communications Leadership Development Program ♦ Champion Learner – Bronze IBM Your Learning Top 10%	♦ ET Most Promising Tech Marketer (CX Category) 2023 ♦ Marketing Award Winner Freshworks Q4 FY25 ♦ Freshworks Top Marketing Leader Q3 2022 ♦ Top Rater Recognition Freshworks 2022–2024 ♦ IBM Forward Thinker Award 2010 & 2015 ♦ Blue Manager Award IBM 2019 ♦ People’s Choice “Role Model” Manager IBM 2021 ♦ IBM Corporate Service Corps Awardee Top 1% Selection ♦ Manager Champions Group (MCG) Member IBM